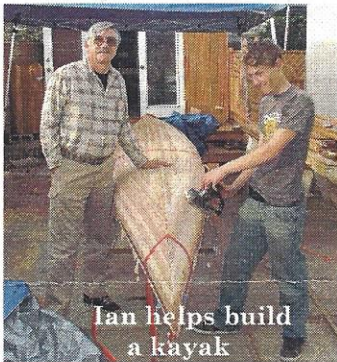


Merry Christmas

Saracoff Sentinel/Team Tijuana

December 2007

Family Photos



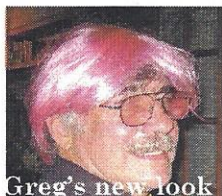
Ian helps build a kayak



Maki, one of several recent houseguests who have blessed our family, came from Japan via Mexico City.



Anna on Halloween



Greg's new look



A Little Girl's Big Problem



Felicia lives next to the Tijuana City dump. She and her five brothers and sisters and parents live in a house without water or electricity. No TV in her room and she does not have a cell phone or go to the mall. Instead, every day after her half day of school, she works in the dump, seeking recyclables.

How would she have time for her home work today and how could she find the privacy and space to do it? All 5 of her brothers and sisters live and sleep in the same 10 by 12 foot room. Her parents would be mad if she did not find some recyclables!

At least Papá had come back to the family. He had been an addict for 10 years. Last Christmas was the first Christmas he had ever spent sober and with the family. Back when he drank it was worse than not having a father. He would use all the family money on his habit and then beat her mother if she tried to hide some money for food. Now he had changed his life and she thought she could even see some tenderness in his actions, "¿Cómo estas, mi Felicita?" he would ask in the morning. Felicia liked to visit her abuela nearby at a home for the elderly and tell her grandma about the good changes in Papá.

Suddenly Felicia smiled; maybe there was a solution! A lady named Chela was coming to the mission church and they had a place to do homework! Also on Saturday some people from a place called Solana Beach



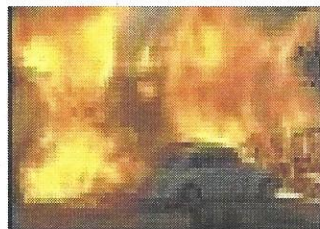
brought a breakfast and some fun crafts. They said wonderful things—that God loved her and that her life could be changed—not only in the future but now by knowing Him. Felicia thought hard. She did not think this was possible before, but now that she could see tenderness in Papá, maybe, just maybe there was a Heavenly Father who cared for her!

This is a composite story. We know children, addicts, and elderly whose stories we have combined into one. With our partners in Team Tijuana, and the help of people like YOU, we see God changing lives!

Fires Threaten California!

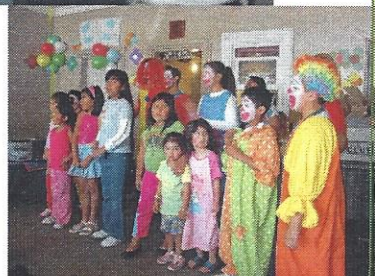
We want to thank those who prayed for us during the fires in October. Over one million people had to evacuate their homes and over 2000 homes were lost north of us. Our friends just east of I-805 stopped by our house, their cars stuffed with their pets, valuables, photos, a few clothes and food items. They spent the night at CV

High School, along with 300 others. Following their example, we began to pack, too—or should I say "Anna packed while Kathy panicked." Fortunately, the reverse



911 call to evacuate never came. It was humbling to get phone calls from concerned friends in Mexico and even Taiwan. One of our supporting churches, Rancho Bernardo Baptist, was saved as 4 firefighters put out a fire on their roof. The church took courage and opened to the public as a shelter. CNN news filmed their Sunday services and a church member led a cameraman to the Lord. See website: www.rbbaptist.org

Kids Club Photos



Three Clubs—Many Needs

Camino Vivo , Carretas, and the Zona Norte are all kids clubs.

Camino Vivos has built a room for children at the dump to use as a homework room. Solana Beach serves breakfasts here once a month. Last club was up to 80 children. They need more teams to serve breakfast here.

Chela has bonded with the children in Carretas and the community donated land to build a youth center. The hillside was leveled . A team built a storage shed and recently put in some fence posts. It is not easy building in this poor area—one sheet of plywood is worth more than what most of these people make in a week. We were appalled to learn that the first fence posts we put in were stolen even though they were seated in concrete. This reminds us again that we're in a spiritual battle for the lives and souls of children. Remember to pray for these needy children and families. Pray for more families and churches to come to our aid to support these clubs and build the center in Carretas. The church in Rancho Bernardo that sustained the fire damage was one of the first to donate to the project. Praise God for Korean and Chinese churches in the LA area that are helping! We see God starting the work but we know that many more need to join the team A family from Seattle is coming before Christmas to build half a basketball court. We are trusting God to provide a group to finance the other half.

In the Zona Norte, Tijuana's red light district, Ana shares the Good News with children of prostitutes at Esperanza's Rescue Mission. She needs \$40 monthly to help with food and gas to get to the Saturday morning club



Don't forget that the back bone of the rehabilitation and elderly ministries are many volunteers working communally with the ministries for food and occasional cash gifts. They have families and children so we try to give them a cash gift at Christmas.

A REVIEW OF 2007— MANY REASONS TO PRAISE GOD!

There are so many things to thank God for since Dec 06. Five areas of ministry that come to mind are:

- (1) The rapid growth of the Refugio for the Elderly to over 115 souls and more church getting involved with the clubs.
- (2) The growth of the three Kids Clubs.
- (3) The beginning of construction for the youth/community center at Carretas with the ground breaking, land-leveling, and building of the first structure.
- (4) New groups helping the drug rehab— building a new dorm, starting a computer lab and expanding the women's rehab.
- (5) Expansion of our efforts in Microfinance which involved us in a start-up group in Tijuana and took both Kathy and me to Oaxaca on trips to help train loan officers there to integrate business with Christian witness. We do this with our partner organization FIPS which now has over 10,000 loans out to indigenous peoples, mostly women, in the south of Mexico.

Latin America Mission
P.O. Box 52-7900
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Please indicate:
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www.lam.org



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